

Constitution of the Furman University Outdoor Club

Last revised August 2023

Exploration. Fear. Triumph. Beauty. It is the mission of the Furman University Outdoors Club (FUOC) to create and support a community of students excited about the experience, education, and preservation of the natural world.

Article I. Name of Organization

The name of this organization will be the Furman University Outdoors Club (FUOC)

Article II. Membership

Section 1. Types of Student Involvement

- Official FUOC Members – These are students who have submitted an updated Club Membership and Liability Waiver form to the FUOC officer team and have paid the annual dues for the current academic year. (Note: all trip attendees MUST have completed both previous requirements)
- Non-Paid Members - These members have submitted and filled out an updated Club Membership and Liability Waiver form but have not yet paid the \$10 academic year dues. These members are not permitted any membership benefits, excluding participation in certain trips, until they submit dues.

Section 2. Official Rights of a FUOC Member

- The following rights are guaranteed to each member who has completed the necessary requirements. Each paid member is permitted to attend all FUOC led trips, permitted to rent gear according to the gear rental guidelines. Furthermore, members may be permitted to the utilization of social media facets laid out by Public Relations that are inclusive of official members only. Note: official members may reference Article V (trip guidelines) for the explanation of entrance into special and possibly exclusive events.

Section 3. Membership Expulsion

- If a member behaves in a manner that could endanger other people or misrepresent FUOC or Furman University, their membership may be revoked by a simple majority vote of FUOC officers. (Note: Members have the right to appeal to the SGA of Furman University if they feel they have been targeted and expelled from FUOC membership for an unfair reason).

Article III. The Larger Administrative and Governing Bodies

Section 1. Levels of Command

1. Executive Committee
2. Officer team
3. Advisors

Section 2. Constituents of Governing Bodies

1. Executive Committee
 - a. This committee consists of the following five positions: President, Vice-President (Head of Field), Treasurer, Quartermaster, and Social Chair.
 - b. These roles are determined by the officer team of the previous year.
2. Officer Team
 - a. New officers will be voted on and inducted at the end of the fall semester (Article VI section 1)
3. Advisors
 - a. Head of the Recreational Department
 - b. Another Faculty advisor of the officers choosing

Traditional positions of this team that must be filled include: President, Vice-President, Secretary, Treasurer, Social Chair, and Quartermaster. At the end of an academic year, the traditional positions in the club must always be filled for the following calendar year. That being said, the roles within the FUOC officer team are highly variable by academic year and are suited to fit the current club needs and the presented skill set of the student body. These non-traditional roles will be determined by the Executive Committee and are subject to change.

The Faculty/Staff Advisor acts as the liaison between the club and the university, advising the group on guidelines, safety, and best practices. There is no term limit for the Faculty/Staff Advisor. If a new advisor needs to be selected, the officer team should identify potential candidates, conduct interviews, and vote on their preference.

Section 3. Responsibilities of Governing Bodies

1. Executive Committee
 - a. It is the duty of this committee to continually evaluate and monitor officer activity in the effort to provide a fair and balanced workload for all officers. It is of equal importance that this committee stay in constant communication about the currently elected team. The management of officer activity includes but is not limited to new officer addition, offer probation, and officer dismissal. A 2/3rds vote is required.
 - b. Attend weekly meetings with the current advisors.
2. Officer Team

- a. It is the responsibility of each officer to:
 - i. Read the constitution once they are inducted
 - ii. Attend all club meetings. This includes being on time and coming prepared with materials.
 - iii. Complete club related tasks relating to their personal strengths, enjoyments, and position responsibilities.
 - iv. Attend a number of weekend trips in which the club leads. This number is subjective by each officer's desire. Attendance at specific events may be requested by the officer team.
 - v. Complete the necessary amount of Rabbit Hole "Office Hours" as determined by the current Quartermaster.
 - vi. Evaluate and vote on the Faculty/Staff Advisor and the new student Officers.
 - vii. Offer aid and support to other officers whom may be dealing with a large amount of club or course related work.
 - viii. Lead at least one trip per semester.
 - ix. Try to expand their knowledge and skills concerning outdoor activities and leadership.
 - x. Become Advanced Wilderness First Aid Certified when the training is available, provided for by the University.
- 3. Advisors
 - a. The Faculty/Staff Advisor is responsible for:
 - i. Safety advice on off campus trips aswell as the general running of the club, including considering all safety and liability concerns for each trip
 - ii. Works as a team with all FUOC officers when making any changes to the club structure, Rabbit Hole, and trip process.
 - iii. Help bridge the gap between FUOC and Furman Faculty
 - iv. Being knowledgeable about university policies and making sure the club is following them
 - v. Making sure the club remains a student-led organization.
 - vi. Be available for general advice
 - vii. Filling out an advisor/club agreement through the Office of Student Life
 - viii. All suggestions requiring money has to be run by and approved by the whole current Excutive team (president, vice president, quarter master, and treasurer).

Section 4. Rights of Governing Bodies

1. Executive Committee

- a. Members of this committee receive no other rights than those of the officers, with the exception of being able to regulate officer activity if need be. The Executive Committee will adhere to the officer managerial regulations of Article VI.
- 2. Officer Team
 - a. Members of this team hold the right to:
 - i. Have a voice on the administration of FUOC at meetings. Is able to partake in votes.
 - ii. Attend all events/trips and rent gear throughout the year free of charge and without paying annual dues.
 - iii. Receive attendance preference over other club members if leading the event or trip in question.
 - iv. Each officer will have Furman ID swipe access to the Rabbit Hole. They will be responsible for their own alarm system code.
 - v. Permitted to membership items (whether it be apparel, gear, sticker, etc.) free of charge.
- 3. Advisors
 - a. The Faculty/Staff Advisor has the right to:
 - i. Attend all administrative meetings
 - ii. Receive one of each ordered membership item
 - iii. Cancel or change any event that does not meet the university conduct or safety guidelines

Article IV. Descriptions of Officer Positions

Section 1. The President

- The President of the Furman University Outdoors Club holds the responsibility of motivating and directing the officer team to most effectively complete the mission which the club stands for (See Article I). Most primarily, this form of motivation and direction is channeled into the management of weekly administrative meetings in which the officer team is encouraged to communicate with the rest of the club officials on various club motions. In a more basic understanding, the president must lead the administrative meetings. Second to this responsibility is the duty of the president to be the representative “face” of the organization when communicating to other organizations or groups on campus. The president ensures that each administrative body in the club is adhering to their responsibilities as described in Article 3, Section 3. It is also the responsibility of the president to bridge the communication between faculty and FUOC officers. It is the shared duty of the president, vice president, quartermaster, and treasurer to submit an update budget request in the spring semester. As a way to keep general members informed, the president is responsible for sending a weekly email containing all relevant

information including trip and event updates. This email should be sent at the beginning of the week, Monday or Tuesday.

- In place of a single president may be two presidents (co-presidents) in which both would have equal shared power of the presidency. Such can be imposed when two officers run for presidency as co-presidents and win the voting majority as a single unit. In the event of a co-presidency, the co-presidents must create a written agreement of each of their delegated or shared duties; these duties will be decided by the co-presidents, depending on each of their strengths or preferences. Such document should be shared with and available to the entire officer team by the start of their term.

Section 2. The Vice President

- The Vice President of the Furman University Outdoors Club is the leader of all non-social trips and events in which the club partakes. Other suitable titles for the Vice President include: Head Trip Coordinator, Trip Leader, and Outdoor Event Organizer. The vice president has the final word on approving, denying, and organizing all club trips (most often weekend trips) which directly involve the outdoors. Therefore, it is the vice president's duty to organize trips with respect to the following: timing, safety, interest, finance, education, fun, and experience. The Vice President reserves the right to select a specific officer of the team to assist them in the management, organization, or logistics of a specific outdoors trip. It is the responsibility of the Vice President and the trip leader to make sure liability waivers are filled out for each student participating on a certain trip. In the absence of the President, or following the resignation of the President, the Vice President will temporarily assume the role of the Presidency until their return, or until a suitable replacement is found. Should the Vice President choose to accept the role of President following the latter's resignation, the Vice President may immediately assume the new position.

Section 3. The Secretary

- The Secretary serves as the scribe during all administrative meetings by documenting important information that is presented relating to club activity. The secretary holds documentation of officer and advisor attendance at all administrative meetings. The secretary faithfully manages and updates club membership records, including attendance of all FUOC trips. It is the responsibility of the event organizer to see that attendance is recorded and given to the Secretary. The secretary reminds officers of club meetings via email and updates officers of their current task list after each meeting. The Secretary also manages, organizes, and safeguards all membership and safety consent forms and holds a master list of various keys, pin codes, and passwords which the club has various uses for. The secretary is in charge of organization, access, compiling, etc. of documents and resources in the google drive. Relevant documents must be placed in the communal

google folder so other officers have access to them. This position may be grouped with other executive positions if the officer team sees fit.

Section 4. The Treasurer

- The Treasurer of the Furman University Outdoors Club manages the budget and checking account of the club and serves as a direct liaison with Furman Student Government Association (SGA). The Treasurer will hold an up-to-date and organized documentation of all club purchases, withdrawals, and transfers from both the external checking account and of the official SGA budget. It is the responsibility of the Treasurer to modify and reallocate funds throughout the year, in a timely manner, with respect to the final decisions of the Officer team. They are responsible for the timely transfer of money collected via annual membership dues and merchandise sales to the external checking account. The Treasurer must bring an updated and detailed outline of the club's budget (both external checking account and SGA) to each administrative meeting.

Section 5. The Quartermaster

- The Quartermaster of the Furman University Outdoors Club holds responsibility over the rabbit hole (the official off campus clubhouse building and property) in terms of:
 - Maintenance requests
 - Care of rental and non-rental items within the rabbit hole
 - Management of officers completing their mandatory office hours.
- In reference to rental items, the quartermaster will be aware of all rental transactions, be responsible for the proper care and return of each item and hold a digital master-list of all items currently in possession by the club. A full gear inventory should be conducted once a semester. In reference to office hours, the quartermaster will be the point of contact and control for scheduling officers for their office hour shifts and ensuring these shifts were completed. The quartermaster is entitled to a team of quartermaster-appointed officers to aid them in their responsibilities.

Section 6. The Committee of Public Relations

- Social Chair – The Social Chair of the Furman University Outdoors Club will manage a group of officers (the Social Bench) that aims at ensuring that the club and its events are effectively advertised and promoted to the student body. The Social Chair often participates (and encourages other members of their committee to participate) in the following publicity actions: Club social media accounts, flyers, dining hall banners, t-shirts, event photography, stickers, etc. It is oftentimes the activity of the social chair to manage this team of artistically inclined individuals to promote the club and its events to the highest manner possible.

- Web Design Manager (optional) – The Web Design Manager of the Furman University Outdoors Club operates all web-based media in the club’s usage. This media includes but is not limited to: the closed Facebook group “FUOC Members Only,” the open facebook page “Furman University Outdoors Club,” the org sync page, and the official FUOC website address fuoc.club. The Web Design Manager’s responsibility is to ensure that the potential information found on these media outlets is both interesting and up-to-date.
- Photographer (optional) – The Photographer of the Furman University Outdoors Club is responsible for the photographic documentation of all events with which the club is involved. The photographer is also responsible for communication with other committee members (specifically the Web Design Manager) to efficiently upload documentation to the media outlets such as Instagram and Facebook.

Article V: Trip and Event Attendance

Section 1. Regular Events

- Most events held by the Furman University Outdoors Club do not have an event population cap. All paid members of the club are eligible to attend the club events and pay no extra event fee.

Section 2. Specialized Events

- Some events held by the club are constituted as “Specialized Events.” These events often have a definitive population cap and sometimes require the members to pay additional fees. All paid members have the possibility of joining these events on a first come, first serve basis.

Section 3. Raffle-Based Trips

- As these events are popular during the year, a raffle system is employed. All paid members are allowed to enter the raffle, and names are drawn until the population cap has been reached. Members that partake in these events are required to pay extra fees if necessary.

Article VI: Officer Additions, Dismissals, and Probation

Section 1. Officer Additions

General officer additions occur through an open application process at the end of the Fall semester. Each applicant is interviewed, after which the entire officer team will vote on new officers. Executive officer positions are similarly voted on by the entire officer team prior to accepting new officers for the upcoming year.

Section 2. Officer Probation

Officers who fail to complete the responsibilities laid out in Article 3, Section 3, # 2, will be subject to officer probation. An officer placed under probation is not permitted to any of the rights given to them in Article 3, Section 4, #2. They are temporarily stripped of their current position and will remain so until they return to good standing with the club and with the Executive Committee. In the event that an accident occurred due to lack of oversight and guidance from a leading officer on a trip probation will be discussed and voted on by the executive team (president, vice president, quarter master, and treasurer). In order for an officer to be put on probation, an Executive Committee meeting must occur in which all constituents agree to the motion. The removal of an officer from probation is entirely subjective to the Executive Committee but requires the approval of all constituents.

Section 3. Officer Dismissals

Officers on probation who lack the potential to return their previous officer positions are subject to dismissal. These officers will be stripped of all ties to the club. This action requires full consent from the members of the Executive Committee. In the case of an executive committee member being dismissed, the officer team will vote on an officer who will fill that position. General officers will be replaced in the next application cycle.

Article VII: Amendments to the Constitution

Section 1. Timeliness of proposed amendment

- Any suggested amendments must be brought to the officer team at least one week prior to voting on that amendment.

Section 2. Majority requisites

- Officers will vote on amendments which must receive a two thirds majority to pass. Only those officers who hold their position at the time of an issue that spurs a potential amendment may vote.

Section 3. Single issue voting

- Amendments will be voted upon individually. If there are several changes being proposed, there will be a vote for each alteration rather than a single vote encompassing two or more amendments.

Section 4. Retrospective changes

- All changes and amendments must be written out in their final form before being voted upon. After the vote is complete, any change made to the constitution without a follow-up vote is invalid.

President

_____Kaya Frawley_____

Vice President

_____Adrian Gonzalez _____